GHANAIAN AND AFRICAN STUDIES

COURSE CODE:UENR110

HANDOUT NOTES

Mode of Course Delivery

- Lectures
- Group Discussion
- Assignments
- Presentation
- Internet Search

Mode of Assessment

- Participation (Attendance, Contribution to discussions, notes taking)
- Presentation
- Assignment
- Mid-Semester
- Final Examination

Course Objectives

- To provide students with knowledge on the histories, cultures and people of Ghana and Africa
- To sensitize students on gender issues to enable them identify and appreciate the effects and significance of gender and cultural issues to development.

What is African Studies

It is the study of:

- The cultural, geographical, socio-economic, and political institution of Africa from earliest to present time.
- The contributions Africans have made to and borrowed from world civilization and mankind.
- African Studies is a multi-faceted and interdisciplinary intellectual pursuits of Africa. (Uchendu 1978)

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Political map of Africa

Africa
International Boundary
AUSTRALIA - Independent State
Capital City
Major City
MOROCCO
ALGERIA
LIBYA
EGYPT
MAURITANIA
MALI
NIGER
CHAD
SUDAN
NIGERIA
CAMEROON
CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC
SOUTH SUDAN
ETHIOPIA
SOMALIA
ERITREA
DJIBOUTI
YEMEN
SAUDI ARABIA
OMAN
IRAN
IRAQ
SYRIA
JORDAN
TURKEY
GREECE
SPAIN
Western Sahara
SENEGAL
GUINEA
SIERRA LEONE
LIBERIA
COTE D'IVOIRE
BURKINA FASO
GHANA
TOGO
BENIN
EQUATORIAL GUINEA
SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE
GABON
REP. OF THE CONGO
DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO
UGANDA
KENYA
RWANDA
BURUNDI
TANZANIA
ANGOLA
ZAMBIA
MALAWI
MOZAMBIQUE
NAMIBIA
BOTSWANA
ZIMBABWE
SOUTH AFRICA
LESOTHO
SWAZILAND
MADAGASCAR
COMOROS
SEYCHELLES
MAURITIUS
Mediterranean Sea
Equator
SOUTH ATLANTIC OCEAN
Ascension
Saint Helena
Lisbon
Rabat
Casablanca
Marrakech
Algiers
Tunis
Tripoli
Cairo
Khartoum
Addis Ababa
Nairobi
Kampala
Kigali
Bujumbura
Kinshasa
Luanda
Lusaka
Harare
Maputo
Pretoria
Johannesburg
Windhoek
Gaborone
Cape Town
Port Elizabeth
Dakar
Bamako
Niamey
Ouagadougou
Abuja
Yaoundé
Libreville
Brazzaville
Mogadishu
Dar es Salaam
Mombasa
Victoria
Antananarivo
Port Louis
Riyadh
Jeddah
Mecca
Baghdad
Tehran
Ankara
Athens
Rome
Palermo
Valletta
Nicosia
Beirut
Damascus
Amman
Tel Aviv-Yafo
Jerusalem
Alexandria
Benghazi
Tripoli
Sana'a
Muscat
Abu Dhabi
Doha
Manama
Kuwait City
Mecca
Medina
Port Sudan
Asmara
Addis Ababa
Hargeysa
Mogadishu
Juba
Khartoum
Omdurman
Kassala
Nyala
Aswan
Alexandria
Cairo
Al Ifzah
Al Basrah
Mosul
Erbil
Tabriz
Qom
Kermanshah
Esfahan
Shiraz
Zahedan
Mashhad
Tehran
Ashgabat
Herat
Kandahar
Izmir
Konya
Adana
Gaziantep
Aleppo
Sicily
Sevilla
Malaga
Gibraltar
Ceuta
Melilla
Fes
Oran
Constantine
Palermo
Malabo
Douala
Yaoundé
Bangui
N'Djamena
Niamey
Kano
Ibadan
Ogbomoso
Lagos
Porto-Novo
Lomé
Accra
Abidjan
Yamoussoukro
Ouagadougou
Bamako
Nouakchott
Timbuktu
Laayoune
Banjul
Bissau
Conakry
Freetown
Monrovia
Praia
Mbuji-Mayi
Lubumbashi
Ndola
Lilongwe
Blantyre
Beira
Bulawayo
Maseru
Mbabane
Durban
Walvis Bay
Benguela
Namibe
Moroni
Mayotte
Juan de Nova Island (Fr.)
Bassas da India (FRANCE)
Europa Island (FRANCE)
Mozambique Channel
Saint-Denis
Reunion (FRANCE)
Tromelin Island (FRANCE)
Glorioso Islands (FRANCE)
Socotra (YEMEN)
Gulf of Aden
Gulf of Guinea
Lake Victoria
Lake Tanganyika
Lake Nyasa
Persian Gulf
Red Sea
Mediterranean Sea
Azores (PORT.)
Madeira Islands (PORT.)
Canary Islands (SP.)
Cabo Verde
Martin Vaz (BRAZIL)
Annobon (EQUA. GUI.)
Pointe-Noire
Kisangani
Kigali
Bujumbura
Dodoma
Lusaka
Harare
Maputo
Mbabane
Pretoria
Johannesburg
Gaborone
Windhoek
Luanda
Kinshasa
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Kassala
Nyala
Aswan
Alexandria
Cairo
Al Ifzah
Al Basrah
Mosul
Erbil
Tabriz
Qom
Kermanshah
Esfahan
Shiraz
Zahedan
Mashhad
Tehran
Ashgabat
Herat
Kandahar
Izmir
Konya
Adana
Gaziantep
Aleppo
Sicily
Sevilla
Malaga
Gibraltar
Ceuta
Melilla
Fes
Oran
Constantine
Palermo
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Douala
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N'Djamena
Niamey
Kano
Ibadan
Ogbomoso
Lagos
Porto-Novo
Lomé
Accra
Abidjan
Yamoussoukro

The concept of African Studies

Before independence, university graduates hardly studied about Africa but studied in detail European and American history and geography. They therefore knew very little or nothing about their own country (Ghana) and Africa.

-They may have learnt about Ghana and Africa only up to the primary level. What they learnt about Africa was European activities in Africa.

- Through **Europeans imperialism and Colonialism**, the Africans have literally come to accept that there is nothing worth learning or studying about Africa. Thus, nothing good is African and any good thing seen in Africa (Ghana) is European creation.

- The European colonists assessed African culture through the eyes of 'European cultures'; and many Ghanaians and Africans held the same view.

The concept of African Studies

To sustain their domination, they (Europeans) employed many **instruments of cultural imperialism** such as:

- Total denial of African history
- Degradation of Ghanaian/African values; and
- Replacement of essential (Ghanaian/African) religious, social, political and economic structures with structures carefully fashioned to ensure total perpetuation (maintenance) of subjugation (suppression) of our people, the nurturing and enhancement of an inferiority complex.

The concept of African Studies

- The institutions therefore nurtured and enhanced inferiority in the African and Ghanaian personality. The education system was structured to achieve these goals.
- For Example:
- African names were frowned upon. The Ghanaian therefore had two names -:
- The European name (Comfort) used at school and church, and the Ghanaian name (Afariwaa) used at home.
- The Ghanaian culture: libation (form of prayer), gods, dancing, dressing among others were all seen as abomination.

The concept of African Studies

- The colonial mentality stifled initiatives because the African was targeted to regard himself, his environment and civilization as inferior. He was therefore salutary (valuable/productive) for himself to depend on the Whiteman. It was fashionable to imitate the Whiteman
- As the European and Africans met there was ACCULTURATION but this was mostly one way.
- The French and Portuguese policies of 'ASSIMILATION' AND ASSIMILADO' were designed to create African Europeans in Africa.
- The Arab imperialism in Africa on the other hand was religio-cultural because the convert was expected to absorbed the entire Muslim (Islamic) cultural practices but not to lose his political identity and kingdom.

Development of African Studies

- African Studies as we know it today has a relatively recent history
- Its remote origins can be traced to the anthropological research activities carried out by adventurers, missionaries, and various categories of imperial administrator in the period just before and immediately following the onset of European colonial rule in Africa. (Olukoshi 2006)
- Its more contemporary origins are tied to the period after 1945 when Area Studies grew in importance in the USA in tandem with the intellectual demands and policy requirements for the strengthening and projection of US power in a post-war world.
- The study of African Studies during this period was to generate research information for the formulation of foreign-policy objectives and strategy towards the developing world

Development of African Studies (cont.)

- The African studies was meant to serve the interest of the USA and the Western Europe and not Africa and her people.
- The African Studies Association was formed at a conference in New York in March 1957 with the aim of improving communication among Africanists, collection and dissemination of information on Africa, and stimulation of research on Africa.
- The period immediately before and after independence was marked by the concept of “African Personality”
- During the declaration of Ghana’s independence in 1957 Nkrumah noted that “We are going to demonstrate to the world, to the other nations, that we are prepared to lay our foundation - our own African Personality”

Development of African Studies (cont.)

- There was therefore the call for Africans to tell African stories from African perspective.
- In ***1962***, Dr. Nkrumah opened the first international congress of African studies in Accra. At the meeting, he criticized the stereotype European thinking about Africa.
- On the 25th October, 1963, the Institute of African Studies was opened at the University of Ghana, Legon.
- Nkrumah charged the Institute with the duty of "re-interpretation and new assessment of the factors which make up our past."
- Over the years, many African scholars have developed and presented African perspectives of African culture, social and political institution, economy, development, music, art etc.

Misconception About Africa

1. Africans had no history.
2. Africans are inferior and barbaric.
3. Africans are uncivilized. (Rudyard Kipling's poem: The White Man's Burden)
4. Africa is the dark continent.
5. Africa is a jungle.
6. The People of Africa are naïve (watch *the Roots* and *the Gods must be crazy)*

The Status of African Studies in Ghana

- University of Ghana has a general and post-graduate programmes.
- University of Cape Coast has general, first degree and post-graduate programmes.
- Students of all public universities and other tertiary institutions are required to do at least a course in African Studies
- African University College of Communication offers first degree programme in African Studies

Objectives for Teaching African Studies in schools

- To help students engage with discourse on African realities.
- To expose African youth to their African background and heritage.
- To overwrite the bias narration about Africa and its people
- To help create awareness of the need to look within to find solutions to African problems.
- To produce genuine knowledge about Africa through scientific and academic rigor.
- To highlight some of Africa's contributions to world civilization.
- To enhance students' knowledge in specific areas of African Humanities and Social Sciences.
- To help students appreciate the contemporary value of African Studies as an area of enquiry.

Problems Hindering the Teaching of African Studies in Schools

- Inadequate documentation on Africa
- Inadequate African specialists (Africanists) to teach the course.
- Eurocentric perspective of existing documentary materials.
- Overly Africanising issues.
- Universities do not attach much attention to the teaching of the course
- Lack of resources
- Political instability

Reading Assignment

- The concept of livelihood and livelihood diversification strategies
- Natural Resources: The types of natural resources and the gendered implications of natural resources management.
- Approaches to theorizing gender and development
- Transforming gender relations and the promotion of gender equitable cultures
- Sustainable development

Culture

- Define culture
- Components and characteristics
- Difference between culture and tradition
- Some cultural terminologies
- Values, Religion, Marriage, Family, Kinship, Inheritance, Chieftaincy and Festivals) and their Importance
- What is the relationship between gender and culture

Definition of Culture

- Culture is from the German word “Kultur” which means civilization.
- *Culture is a complex whole which includes knowledge, beliefs, arts, morals, laws, customs and any other capabilities and habits acquired by man* (a person) *as a member of a society*.(E.B. Taylor 1871)
- *The whole complex of distinctive spiritual, material, intellectual and emotional features that characterize a society or social group. It includes not only arts and letters, but all modes of life, the fundamental rights of the human being, value systems, traditions and beliefs* (UNESCO 1982).

Definition of Culture (Cont.)

- Culture is the way of life of a group of people. It consist of their values, food, clothing, festival, chieftaincy, customs and tradition, inheritance, religion, marriage, arts, music etc. The various ethnic groups in Ghana and Africa such as the Gas, Ewes, Yako, Nuer, Dinka, Swazi, Bantu Igbos, Yorubas, Zulus, Dagombas and Nzemas have their own cultures which make them unique from each other.
- Culture is the totality of human endeavour in a given time and space.
- Culture is the every day expression and future aspirations of a particular group of people.

Forms (Composition) of Culture

1. Material (Arts, Architecture)
2. Non-Material (customs, beliefs, practices, knowledge, etc.)

Components of Culture

- Symbols
- Language
- Values
- Norms
- Artifacts (Technology)

Characteristics of Culture

Culture is:

a. Dynamic

b. Socially constructed

c. Some cultural practices create gender inequality

d. Modification in some cultural practices promote gender equality

Culture is not:

- Static
- The same as tradition
- Does not have inherent elements that retard development

Some Cultural Terminology

- Cultural shock
- Cultural diffusion
- Cultural relativity
- Cultural universal
- Ethnocentrism
- Acculturation
- Cultural lag
- Cultural Assimilation
- Cultural adaptation

Culture is Dynamic and is Socially Constructed:

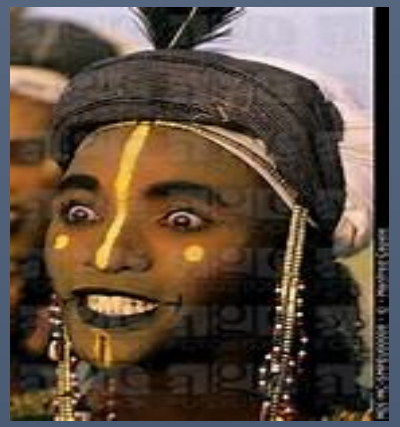
1. Among the Nnandi people of Western Kenya female marry females as husbands and they are also allowed to play all male roles including politics (Sacks, 1982)

2. Among the Lovedu (S/A) and Igbo in Nigeria a woman can be a wife and marry another woman to be their husband (Sacks, 1982; Eskeridge, 1998)

3. Among the Uduke people of Eastern Sudan free marriage (Kerane, 2004)

4. Leviratic marriage among the Tswana (Schapera 1953)

Culture is dynamic and is socially constructed



Tradition

- Tradition is the transmission of customs or beliefs, rituals that has been passed down from generation to generation. They are not written in the sacred book of a religion, such as the Bible, but are considered holy or true.

African:

- Values
- Religion
- Kinship
- Family
- Marriage
- Inheritance
- Chieftaincy
- Festivals

Ghanaian and African Cultural Values

- **Values** – are the important and lasting beliefs or deeds shared by the members of a culture about what is good or bad and desirable. They are the major influence on a person's behaviour and attitudes.
- **Values-** belief about what is right , wrong and what is important in life.
- A culture's standard for discerning what is good and just in the society.
- **Personal values** – core beliefs, and philosophies that one hold about life, its purpose and our own purpose
- **Belief** is the conviction or acceptance that people have or hold that something is especially without proof.
- **Norms** – Are the standards of behaviour that are accepted within a particular group or society.
- Is the visible and invisible rules of conduct through which societies are structured.

Ghanaian and African Cultural Values (Cont.)

1. **Godliness:**

- Sense of sacred and of religion
- Sense of sacredness of life

2. Respect

- Sense of respect for authority and the elders – e.g acknowledge an elder, serve them first, offer seat, allow them to ask question
- Showing or pointing at things – use the right hand (not index finger)
- Don’t show anger, frustration or importance publicly
- Do not talk at meeting time /table
- Sense of good human relations – e.g: Greetings- hello and handshake

Ghanaian and African Cultural Values (Cont.)

3. Honour

- Sense of language and proverbs
- Sense of hard work

4. Hospitality

- Sense of generosity especially to strangers

5. Gratitude

- Receive gifts with both hands
- Thanking a person who has offered a helping hand

Ghanaian and African Cultural Values (Cont.)

6. National Pride

- Sense of belong to the best group (ethnic group)
- Sense of community life
- Sharing personal space (social being not individual)

7. Moral Values

- Boys and girls are supposed to be completely ignorant of sexual matters until they physiologically and socially matured

8. Motherhood

- Sense of being married
- Sense of being a good wife (obedient to her husband, faithful, hard-working, helpful and not quarrelsome)
- Sense of giving birth (being fertile)

Ghanaian and African Cultural Values (Cont.)

9. Motherliness

- Provide by preparation, adequate food for her own children and husband
- Kindness, generosity concern for other peoples well-being

Religion

The awareness of the existence of some ultimate, supreme being (reality) who is the origin and the sustainer of this universe and the establishment of constant ties with this being. (Gyekye 1996:3)

- The African world into which European Christians missionaries entered in the late 17th Century was a religious world in which the idea of God as the Supreme Being was already known and held by the people.
- In African Life and thought, the religious is not distinguished from the non-religious, the sacred from the secular, the spiritual from the material.
- Religion is the totality of life and to every aspect of life is linked religion.
- J.S. Mbiti remarked that the African is notoriously religious and that religion permeates every aspect of the life the African

Some Fundamental Beliefs and Practices of African Traditional Religion

- God (the Ultimate Reality)
- Divinities (Small Gods, Smaller Deities)
- Ancestors
- Witches and Wizards
- Magic and Sorcery
- Libation
- Divination
- Festivals

Kinship

Kinship is the key to the understanding of traditional societies. This is so because it is the basis for the organization of many groups and relationships around which the fabric of social life is built.

- *Kinship refers to social relationship derived from consanguinity, marriage and adoption*. (Nukunya 2003:17)
- Kinship relationships are governed by specific rules and patterns of behaviour as well as reciprocal duties, obligations and responsibilities.
- The patterns of behaviour associated with relatives in a society, together with the principles governing these behaviours are usually referred to as the ***Kinship System***. (Nukunya 2003)

Decent Groups

- Decent may be seen as the process by which direct genealogical connection is traced between an individual and his forbears or offspring for the purpose of recruitment into kin group.(Nukunya 2003)
- When the connection is traced through the male line, it is called *patrilineal decent* (Ga, Ewe, Tallensi, Dagomba etc.)
- When the connection is traced through the female line, it is called *matrilineal decent* (Akans)
- There two main decent groups: ***Clan*** and ***Lineage***
- Not all societies in African have their social organizations regulated by kinship. There places where age set or age grade systems are predominant (yako, Ibo, Nuer, Bemba etc).

Importance of Kinship

- Kinship system prescribes statuses and roles to people who are in a particular relationship.
- It regulates the religious life of the people (it determines those who should worship at a specific ancestral shrine and who should officiate etc.)
- The economic life is also regulated by kinship through inheritance, property relations and residential patterns
- Political roles and responsibilities, as well as succession are governed by kinship.
- Etiquette is influenced by the kinship system through the principle of seniority, the respective position of men and women in society, of old and young, father and child, mother and child, husband and wife, etc.

Family

Types of Family

1. Nuclear (monogamous) family made up of parents and children
2. Extended family made up of grandparents, parents, uncles, aunts, nephews, nieces children and grand children
3. Polygamous Family

Families can also be divided into: family of procreation and the family of orientation.

Functions of the Family

- Procreation
- Socialization
- Economic cooperation

Marriage

- Marriage is a basic institution in every human society
- It is the recognized social institution for establishing and maintaining family as well as sustaining the kinship ties
- Marriage is any union in which the couple have gone through all the procedures recognized in the society for the purpose of sexual intercourse, raising of a family, or companionship. (Nukunya 2003:42)
- It is said that Ghanaian marriage is between families and not individuals.

Marriage (Cont.)

- For marriage to be legal it must pass through the laid-down customary stages for the society:

a. Marriage payment
b. Formal handing over of the bride by her parents to the bridegroom and her parents
c. Marriage ceremony itself
d. Consummation of the union (as in some societies)

Kinds of Marriage in Africa

- Polygyny
- Polyandry
- Levirate
- Woman to woman
- Ghost Marriage

Steps in Contracting Marriage

- Knowing of persons by the individuals and their families
- Man's family donates drinks as Knocking
- Setting of date for marriage
- Customary Marriage (Payment of Bride wealth)
- Church/Mosque marriage (wedding/blessing/signing)
- Both the customary and ordinance marriages are legal marriages

Marriage and Residential Pattern

- ***Patrilocal Residence***- when a couple lives in the husband's father's compound
- **Virilocal Residence**- when they live in a house provided by the man.
- ***Matrilocal Residence***- Couple lives with the wife's family or kin group
- ***Uxorilocal Residence***- When the couple lives in a house provided by the wife
- ***Avunculocal Residence***- Couple lives with the husbands maternal uncle
- ***Duolocal Residence*** -couple continues to live separately in their own natal homes after marriage

Importance of Marriage

What are the importance of marriage?

Succession and Inheritance

Succession refers to the transmission of status or position whereas inheritance denotes transmission property

1. Matrilineal – Inheritance through the mothers line – Akans
2. Patrilineal - Inheritance through the fathers line – Gas, Ewes, Dagombas, Frafras

Chieftaincy

- The traditional African political organization before colonial rule was categorized into two main groups:
- Centralized (Akan, Ewe, Ga, Gonja, Dagomba, Zulu of South Africa, Bemba of Zambia and the Ngwato of Botswana)
- Non- centralized or Acephalous (Tallensi, Nuer of Sudan, and the Logoli of Kenya, Ibo of Nigeria)
- During the colonial rule, most of the acephalous societies were reorganized and the centralized states also strengthened especially in the British territories for easy administration through the indirect rule.

Chieftaincy (Cont.)

- In Ghana, the chieftaincy institution runs parallel with the national (state) institutions.
- The state is concerned with general well being of the citizens through maintenance of peace and order and the development of entire nation,
- The chieftaincy institution is responsible of upholding cultural values and traditions.
- The chieftaincy institution is always headed by a King or Paramount Chief.
- The selection and installation chiefs and associated rituals differ in each society.

Chieftaincy (Cont.)

Some Chiefly Positions in Ghana

- King
- Paramount Chief
- Queen Mother
- Divisional Chief
- Linguist
- Village head (*odikuro* among the Akans)

Each of the positions have its own privileges and responsibilities

A Chief in the Southern Ghana

A Chief in the Northern Ghana

Queen Mothers

Festivals

- Festivals are important occasion in the life of Ghanaians and Africans as whole.
- Festivals are occasion that mark an important event in the lives of the people who celebrate them such as:
- Victory over war;
- Freedom from tyrannical ruler;
- Migration to present community;
- Victory over hanger
- Commemorating the achievement of fore bearers (ancestral festival)
- Commemorating the birth or death of an important leader (religious or political)

Some Festivals in Ghana

Festival	People who Celebrate it
Homowo	Ga
Aboakyer	Efutu/Winneba
Odwira	Akuapem
Hogbetsotso	Anlo
Adae Keseɛ	Asante
Damba	Ethnic groups in the Northern region
Apoɔ	Bono of Techiman
Kundum	Nzimaa
Feo	Kasena
Adankwya	Frafras
Nkyefie	Several Bono Communities
Fetu	Fantes of Cape Coast

Festivals Associated with Christianity and Islam

CHRISTIANITY	ISLAM
Christmas	Idir Ahda
Easter	Idir Fitr

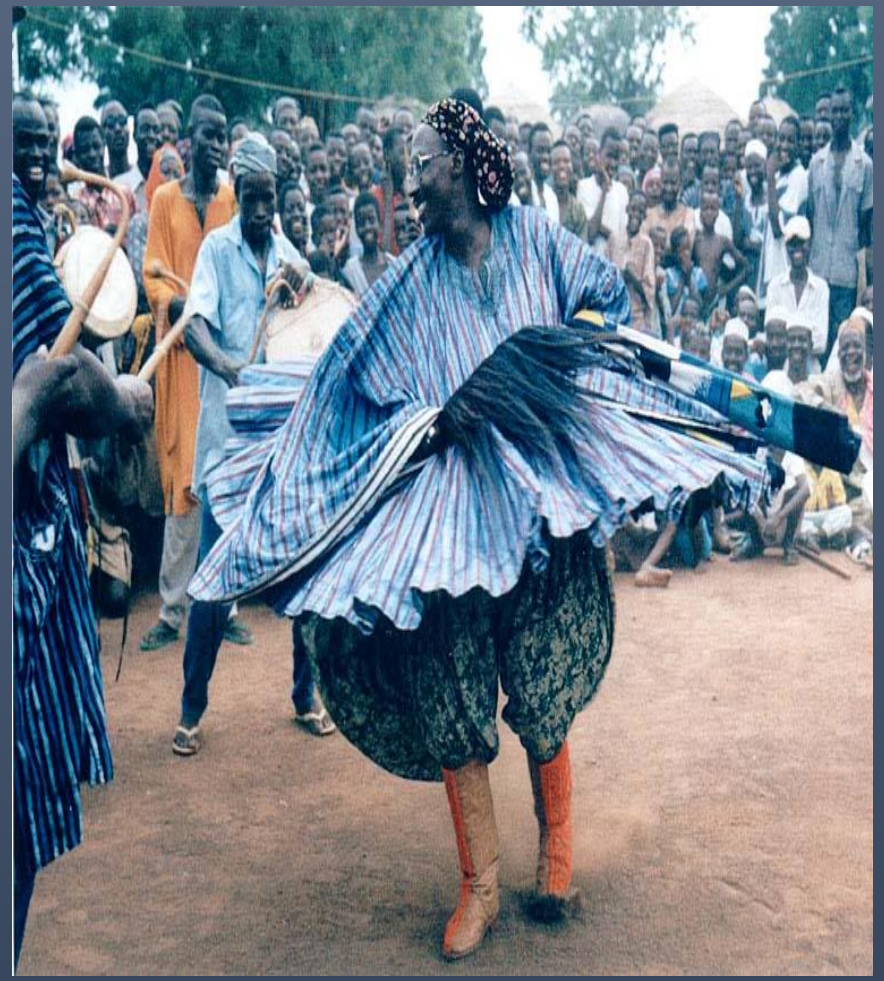
Importance of Festivals in Ghana

The importance of festivals in Ghana can be grouped under the following:

- Historical
- Religious
- Social
- Economic
- Political
- Cultural
- Moral

Festival Scenes in Ghana

Festival Scenes in Ghana



Festival Scenes in Ghana

Festival Scenes in Ghana

Festival Scenes in Ghana

The Social Construction of Gender

- Society
- Patriarchy
- Gender and Sex
- What does the Ghanaian society expect from men and women?
- What men and women can do when not restricted. (SOCIETY FROWNS WHEN YOU DO IT)

What is Society

The roots of the term society can be traced to the Latin word *socius* which means companionship or friendship.

According to MacIver (1931), *"Society is a system of usages and procedures, of authority and mutual aid, of many groupings and divisions, of controls of human behaviour and of liberties. This ever-changing complex system we call society. It is the web of social relationships"*.

Society is complex of groups in reciprocal relationships, interacting upon one another, enabling human organisms to carry on their life-activities and helping each person to fulfill his wishes and accomplish his interests in association with his fellows

Characteristics of a Society

- Interdependence
- Cooperation
- Society also implies difference
- Conflict
- Permanent organization
- Likeness
- Abstract
- Competition
- It is organised (have division of labour)
- It is always changing.
- It has it own way to survive

Patriarchy

- Is a systemic societal structures that institutionalise male physical, social, economic and political power over women.
- Patriarchy is the rule by the father or a male authority. It most often refers to the political power and authority of males in a society. Patriarchy can also refer to the power of fathers within families
- A society may also be considered patriarchal when the heads of households or leaders of the country must possess conventionally accepted male attributes, such as physical strength or aggressive behaviour, to gain and keep their positions.

Definition of Gender

- According to Reeves & Baden (2000), gender refers to the distinctive patterns of ideas, beliefs and norms which shape the way of life and relations of males and females as groups in society. Included in these patterns of ideas are expectations and characteristics, as well as aptitudes and likely behaviours of manhood and womanhood.
- NOTE: Europe and Africa differ in culture, values and identities. The application of gender in these contexts also differs in application.

Definition of Sex

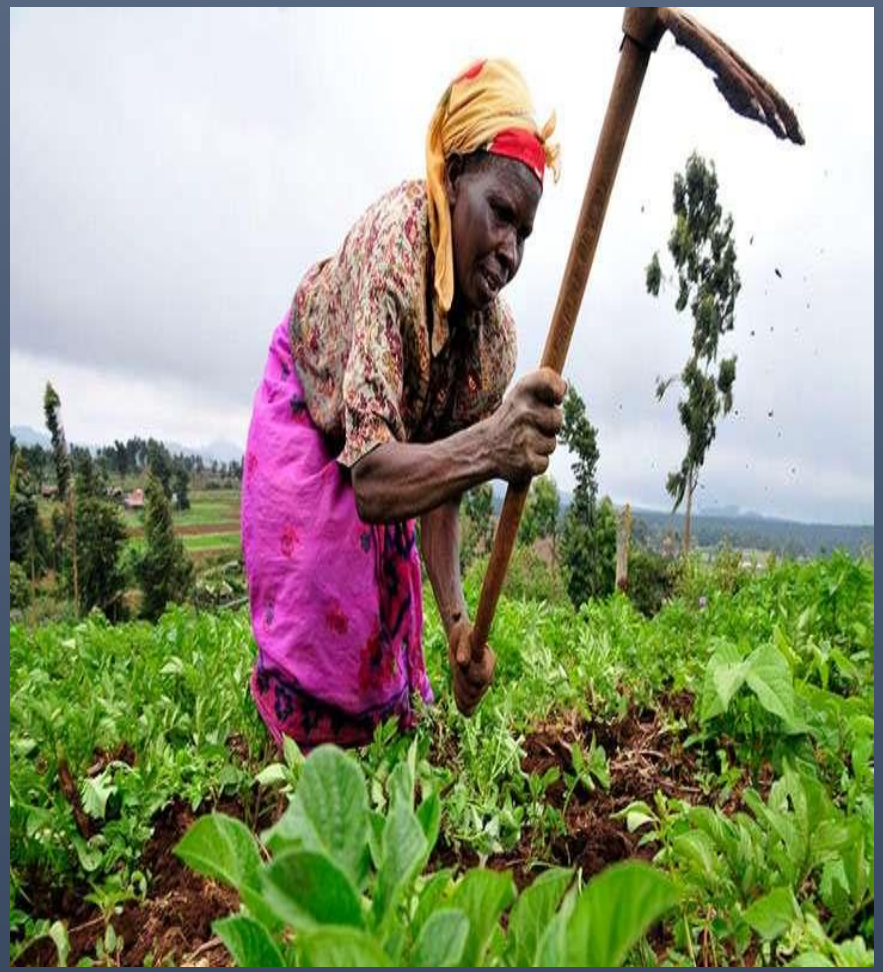
- Sex is the biological difference between men and women. It classifies someone as either a female or male. Sex difference or roles are the same across the world and they are natural, fix and unchangeable (constant).
- In the Ghanaian and African societies, roles are assigned based on sex and gender

"While almost everyone is born with a particular sex and we are either female or male, we are not born with a gender, we grow into one, or are given. We can say therefore that females and males are born but women and men are made." (Ampofo 2013: 95)

What the Ghanaian society expect from men and women

S/N	MEN	WOMEN
1.	Men should pay the dowry/bride price	Should be married by men
2.	Men should be the head of the family	Should be dependant as children
3.	Own and control property	Women and children should be seen but not to be heard
4	Independent and decision makers	Subject to the control of men (Widow seen as witches especially when poor)

What the Ghanaian society expect from men and women.



What men and women can do when not restricted by Society

S/N	MEN	WOMEN
1.	Washing wives clothes: panties, braziers etc.	Taking decisions for self and family
2.	Going to the market	Running a business alone
3.	Bathing children	Not having a household/children
4.	Carrying lady’s bag	Proposing to a man

What men and women can do when not restricted by Society.

Sex Roles

S/N	FEMALE	MALE
1.	Women get pregnant and gives birth	Men make women pregnant
2.	women produce breast milk	men produce sperm
3.	develops breast and breast feeds children	growing beard and voice breaking
4.	Women have vagina and menstruates	Have pennies and testicles
5.	Do not generally have more massive bones	Generally have more massive bones than women

Gender Roles

S/N	FEMALE	MALE
1.	Caring for Children	Disciplines Children
2.	Prepares Breakfast/ Meals	Go Hunting
2.	Fetch water / washes / scrubs (Home Keeping)	Household Repairing
4.	Fish Mongers	Fishermen
5.	Productive activities in the home	Productive activities outside the home
6.	Subordinate, dependent and passive	Independent, invulnerable, aggressors and providers

NOTE

- Gender is useful as a social construct which is defined by beliefs, norms and practices of a particular society.
- Use the example from Agikuyu, Akamba and Nandi of Kenya and Nomadic Gabra of Kenya to emphasise social construction of gender.
- These roles, responsibilities, attributes, behaviours etc. which are socially constructed is subject to change depending on the belief of the particular society. Gender is an acquired identity that is learned, changes with time and varies widely within and across culture. Gender is determined by factors such as sex, age, culture, ethnicity, status and place.
- The difference between men and women (male and female) is caused by SOCIALIZATION. For example at the early stage of development girls were asked to sweep, cook, scrub or keep the house while the boys were asked to weed and do other jobs that need more energy, thus they (both sexes) grow to belief and accept these as their responsibilities.
- Sex is biologically determined, universal for all humans, unchanging and inborn.

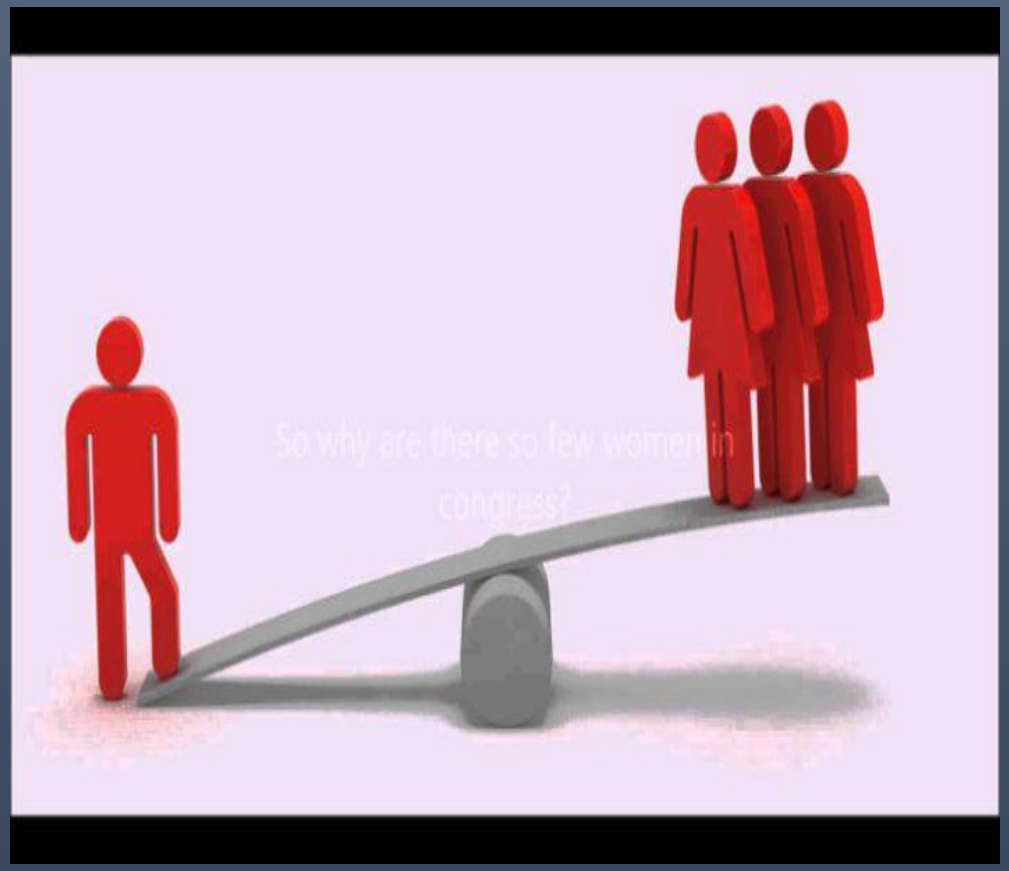
Identify statements that relate to gender and sex

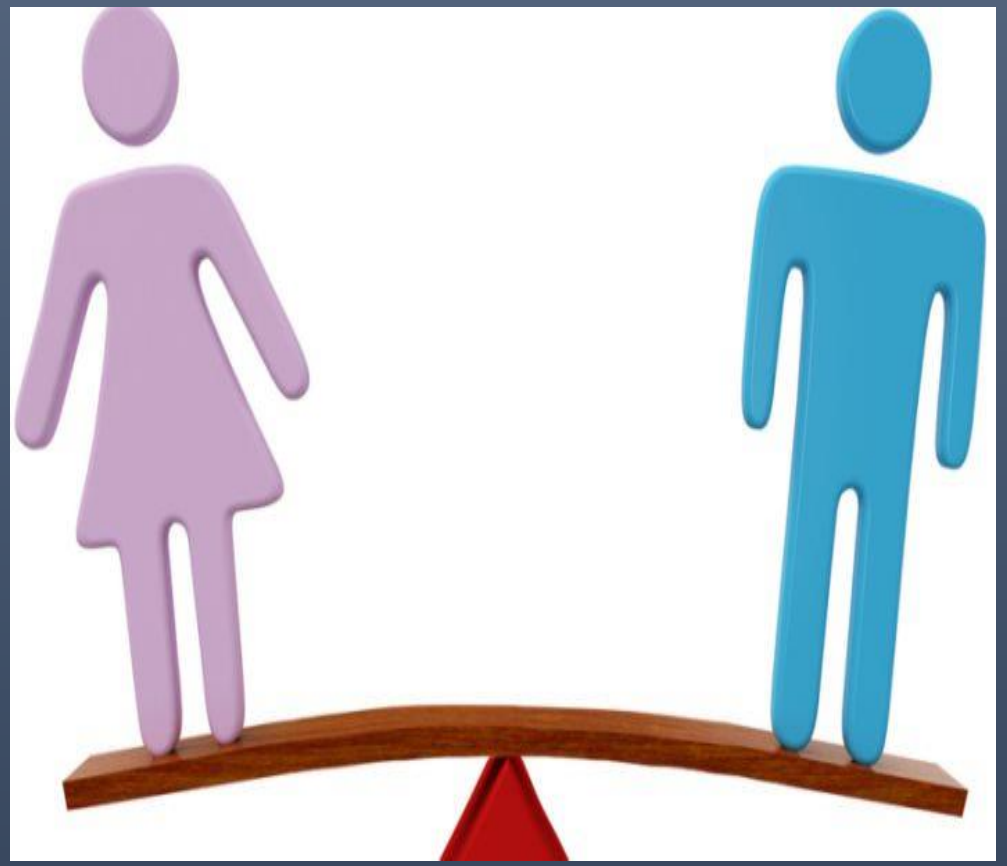
STATEMENT	GENDER	SEX
Women earn less money than men do		
Men Can't Cook		
Women have larger breast than men		
Husband can not follow his wife on a diplomatic posting		
Girls drop out of school more that boys do		
A man is the head of the household		
It is not the duty of the father to change diapers		
Men don't cry		
A wife cannot initiate sex with the husband A man cannot get pregnant		
Men make good Doctors; women make good nurses		

Gender Inequality

- Gender inequality
- Difference between gender equality and gender equity
- Historical perspective of gender inequality
- Factors that account for gender inequality
- The nature of gender inequality in Ghana
- Agents of Socialization and Gender Inequality
- Cultural practices that perpetuate gender inequality
- Why is gender inequality an issue in Ghana

Gender Inequality





Inequality

Equality

Gender Inequality

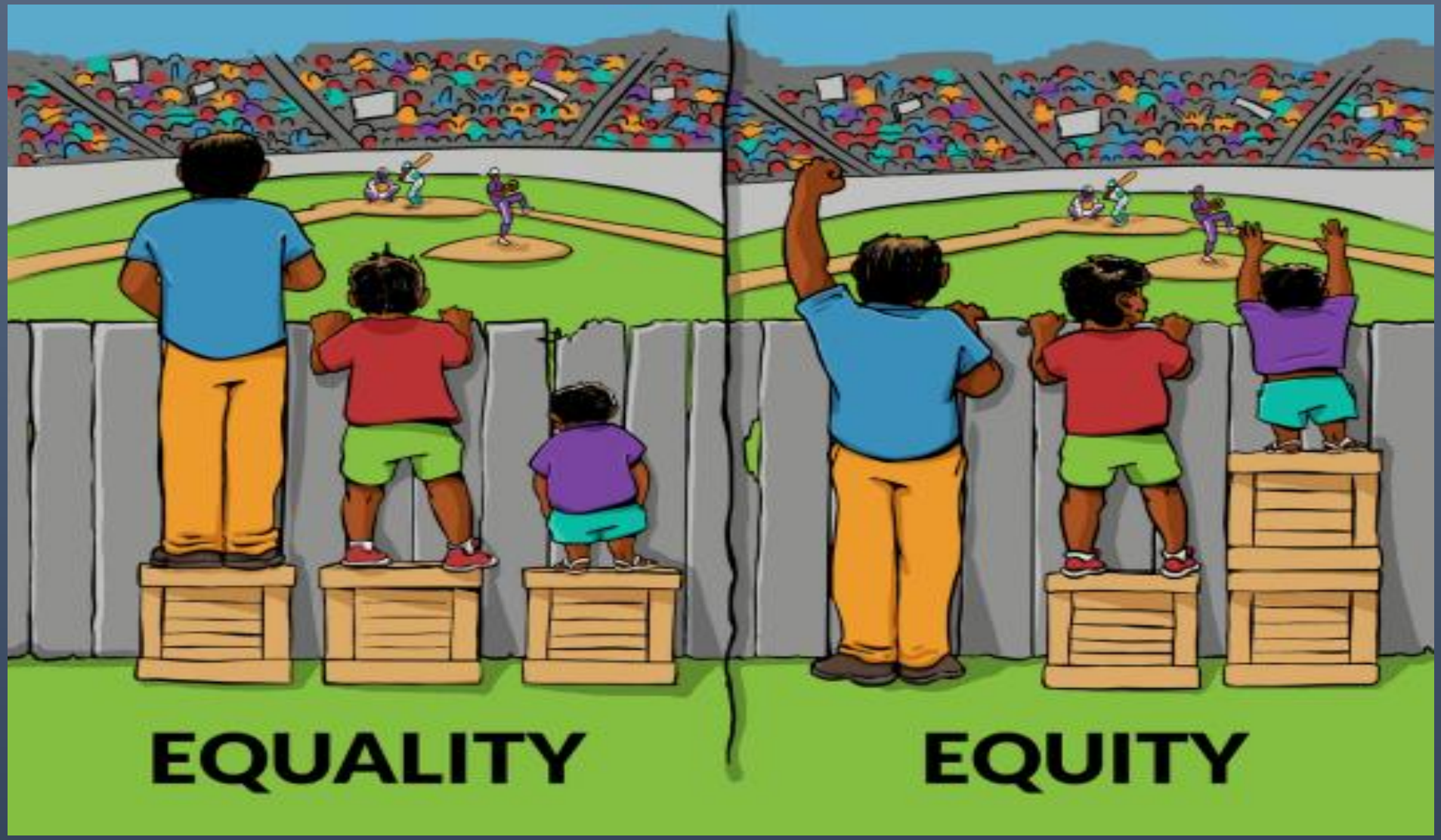
Gender inequality refers to an unequal opportunities, rights and responsibilities for women and men, girls and boys.

- Gender inequality is not perpetuated exclusively through differential access to and control over material resources. Gender norms and stereotypes reinforce gendered identities and constrain the behaviour of women and men in ways that lead to inequality.
- Regardless of one's socioeconomic class, there are systematic gender differences in material well-being, although the degree of inequality varies across countries and over time.

Gender Inequality

- It manifests as hierarchical gender relations, with men above women, and women being regarded as inferior and less valuable solely by virtue of their sex.
- Gender inequality is a characteristic of most societies, with males on average better positioned in social, economic, and political hierarchies.
- However, in some societies men also suffer from behaviors and policies that foster hierarchical gender relations.
- Inequalities in societies are determined by factors such as sex, age, culture, ethnicity, status and place

Gender Equality vs. Gender Equity



Gender Equity

- Gender equity denotes the equivalence in life outcomes for women and men, recognizing their different needs and interests, and requiring a redistribution of power and resources. (Hazel and Sally 2000)
- Equity recognises that women and men have different needs, preferences, and interests and that equality of outcomes may necessitate different treatment of men and women.

For example the target of achieving gender parity in education in Ghana is 1:1 (GPI). Given that females constitute about 51% of the population, we are talking about equality but not equity.

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality

The ranging argument has been whether gender inequalities were inherent in the pre-colonial traditional society or were created and perpetuated by the colonial and post- colonial state.

- Scholars argued that in pre-colonial Africa, women played different roles that were complementary to those of men. They played important roles such as mothers, sisters, wives, chiefs, queens and priestesses.
- Scholars of Akan society noted several characteristics of gender relations which suggest marked jural equality.

✓Lack of basic sex discrimination in the roots of the kinship terminology.

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Studies of the coastal Ga and Fante women traders of Ghana noted their financial autonomy and household decision making clout (Ampofo 2013)
- Politically, pre-colonial African women played important roles as leaders- as kings and queens, chiefs, priests and priestesses, warriors, leader of clans and lineage

✓Several military groups had female wing who led war companies and women were celebrated in poetry and performance (eg. Poetry of Ifa, the major Yoruba divinity)

✓Duality of power was built into the political system(Swazi and Sotho of Southern Africa, the Asante, Baule, Hausa and Wolof of West Africa.

✓It has been noted that on no other continent do women play as many different and important roles as in Africa. (Ampofo 2013:106)

All-female military regiment of the Kingdom of Dahomey (Benin)

Nana Yaa Asantewaa

Famous Words of Yaa Asantewaa

- “Now I have seen that some of you fear to go forward to fight for our king. If it were the brave days of Osei Tutu, Okomfo Anokye and Opoku Ware I, chiefs would not sit down to see their king taken without firing a shot. No white man could have dared to speak to the Chief of Asante in the way the governor spoke to you chiefs this morning. Is it true that the bravery of Asante is no more? I cannot believe it. It cannot be! I must say this: if you, the men of Asante, will not go forward, then we will. I shall call upon my fellow women. We will fight the white men. We will fight till the last of us falls on the battlefield.”
- Yaa Asantewaa was chosen by a number of regional Asante kings to be the war-leader of the Asante fighting force. This is the first and only example for a woman to be given that role in Asante history. The Ashanti-British "War of the Golden Stool" was led by **Queen Mother Nana Yaa Asantewaa** with an army of 5,000.

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- The above discussions do not exonerate the pre-colonial societies from gender inequalities as not many women enjoyed the above opportunities as compared to men.
- There were equally a good number of cultural practices that subordinated women:
  - Early marriage
  - Wife inheritance
  - Polygyny
  - Wife seclusion
  - Widowhood rites
  - Female genital cutting

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Colonial rule, contact with new religions, access to western education, a modern cash economy and formal wage sector have all played important roles in creating and perpetuating gender inequalities.
- British in consolidating colonial rule contained women and men on terms unfamiliar to them.
- They imposed western notion of household organization and gender on local conceptualization and instil new notion of housewifery (Hansen 1991:5)
- To a large extent “modernization” of traditional institutions brought women exclusion.

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Women were not recognized in the colonial chiefs list nor as members of the native councils or courts
- Among the Swazi, the attempts at modernizing the traditional state resulted in the retention of the power in the position of the *ngwenyama*(king) and his council (*liquoquo*) to the detriment of the *indlovukati* (queen)
- Changes in farming system enhanced men's prestige at the expense of women by widening the gap in their knowledge levels and by reducing women’s roles to those of mere labourers while men earn cash directly from the sale of their produce

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Sex discrimination was inherent in the missionary education and colonial administrative system

✓There was an emphasis on males education to prepare men for entry into the civil service.

✓When girls went to school, it was geared towards domestic training (home management and cookery)

✓Men were perceived and trained to be “breadwinners” while women were expected to support men.

- The indissolubility of Christian marriage
- Restrictions on women in the new job opportunities (in the British colonies once a woman got married she had to resign from the civil service)

Historical Perspective of Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Kwame Nkrumah's post- independence government is credited for creating space for women, even unschooled women.
- After independence women were appointed to ministerial positions alongside men.
- However this was not generally the case across Africa and political patron-client relations tended to favour men, particularly elite men, for political office.
- Since independence, there have been several attempts at eliminating gender inequalities in Ghana and African, yet gender inequality is still prevalent in our society.

REFLCTION

- Distinguish between equality and equity
- Gender equality is not the best policy. Explain.
- Mention two colonial factors that have contributed to gender inequality in Ghana.

Factors that Account for Gender Inequality

- Patriarchal nature of society
- Marriage (early marriage, polygyny, payment of bride wealth etc.)
- Religious practices (trokosi, some Christian and Muslim practices)
- Violence against women
- Socialization
- Language usage (proverbs and idioms)
- Preference for sons to daughters
- Historical antecedent

The Nature of Gender Inequality in Ghana

- Low representation in decision making (parliament, ministerial appointment, MMDCEs, Assembly members and unit committee members)

✓ For the 7th parliament of the Fourth Republic, out of the 275 parliamentarians only 35 representing 12.75% are women

✓30 out of the 275 Parliamentarians representing 10.91% were women in the 6th Parliament of the Fourth Republic

- Comparatively low enrolment, retention and completion rates in schools especially at the secondary and tertiary levels
- Women still occupy the ebb of the agricultural production chain
- Low access to land and landed resources
- Women continue to suffer violence (physical, psychological and sexual violence)
- Poor access to health services

Agents of Socialization and Gender Inequality

The way people are socialized into the society goes a long way to influence their actions, inactions and perceptions in life. The agents of socialization have profound impact on gender inequality.

- Family

✓Gender role for boys and girls

✓Behaviour of parents at home

✓Values parents place on sons

- School

✓Prefectorial system

✓Writing of names in the register

✓Absence of sanitary facilities in schools

✓Cleaning and grounds work

Agents of Socialization and Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Peer groups
- Community
  - ✓ The happenings in the community
  - ✓ Community role differentiation
- Mass media
  - ✓ The image of women in the media

Agents of Socialization and Gender Inequality (Cont.)

- Religion

✓Segregation in churches and mosques

✓Exclusion of menstruating women from ritual performances

✓Absence of women as religious leaders in many religious groups

Cultural Practices that Perpetuate Gender Inequality

1. Marriage by abduction
2. Child Marriage
3. Virginity Testing
4. Preference of a son to a girl
5. Education of male (The place of the female is the home, kitchen)
6. Tribal Marks
7. Female Genital Mutilation (FGM)

Cultural Practices that Perpetuate Gender Inequality (Cont.)

8. Female infanticide (selective abortion, foeticide – because the society values male and considers females of less value: some economic provisions and legislatures also render females worthless)
9. Early Marriage and Dowry
10. Early Pregnancy, nutritional taboos and practices related to child delivery
11. Violence against women
12. Witch Camps

Why is Gender Inequality is an Issue in Ghana

- Affects Planning and Decision Making
- Prevents sustainable (people-centred) development
- Leads to the abuse of social justice and human right
- Interrupts the development process

Reflection

How does gender inequlity play out in Ghana? Give three example.

Transforming Gender Relations

- Social Relations
- Gender Relations
- Elements of Gender Relations
- Ways of Transforming Gender Relations

Social Relations

- Social relations is multifaceted, and includes the diverse set of interpersonal relationships and exchanges that people exchange in both within and between families, friendship and ‘group affiliations’ (Antonucci, 1994)
- Social Relations shapes the roles, resources, rights and people, access and claim. It gives clue to how inequalities are reproduced in institutions through social relations.
- Social Relation plays a vital role because it determines the roles, position, privileges and power.

Gender Relations

Is the way in which a culture or society defines rights, responsibilities and identities of men and women in relation to one another. It is about the way:

- Power is dealt with within the sexes
- Responsibilities are allocated
- Value is given to the sex
- It’s about connection and mutual support
- Separation and connection
- Differences and inequalities

Gender Relation (Cont.)

- Hierarchical relations of power between women and men that tend to disadvantage women.
- These gender hierarchies are often accepted as ‘natural’ but are socially determined relations, culturally based, and are subject to change over time.
- Gender relations constitute and are constituted by a range of institutions, such as the family, legal systems or the market.

Elements of Gender Relations

- Division of Labour
- Productive and Reproductive Roles
- Male roles and responsibilities are valued more than women's roles and responsibilities
- Control of Resources (Land, Power, Labour, Education, Training, etc)
- Gendered ideologies (ideas of acceptable behaviour for women and men)

Note: Gender relations are strengthen by socialization

Ways of Transforming Gender Relations

If gender is about relations between men and women, then the male side of the equation must also be figured in. If women's gender identities are to be changed, then men's must change also.' (White in Macdonald, 1993:20)

There are several ways in transforming gender relation to ensure equality and equity. These include:

1. **Reforming family socialization process**

✓Ensuring all children(boys and girls) undertake the same household chores (sweeping, cooking, fetching water, etc.) at home

Ways of Transforming Gender Relations (Cont.)

- ✓Parents must set practical example by participating in all work at home.
- ✓The traditionally held proviso that the training of boys is the responsibility of men whiles female do the training of girls must not be perpetuated.

2. Educating girls or women

- ✓Families must ensure that boys and girls get the same opportunity to attend and attain high educational levels
- ✓"When you educate a man you educate an individual but when you educate a woman you educate the whole nation". (Kwegyir Aggrey)

Ways of Transforming Gender Relations (Cont.)

3. Review of some socio-cultural practices

- ✓Child betrothal or marriage should stop by the family
- ✓Families must be aware of the harmful effects of certain religious practices such as the *trokosi*, *genital cutting*, *widow marriage*.

4. Affirmative action

- ✓Affirmative action is where a series of deliberate and intentional efforts are made to provide opportunities to the marginalized, vulnerable and disadvantage groups in a given society or establishment to become represented. (Adoo-Adeku 2014: 197)

Ways of Transforming Gender Relations (Cont.)

- ✓Affirmative action and the political structure.
- ❖Reducing the falling fee for female aspirants for political positions
- ❖constitutional quota system for females in political appointments
- ✓Educational institutions and affirmative action
- ❖Different cut off aggregates for female and male applicants to the universities and other tertiary institutions with that of females being lower.
- ❖Scholarship for girls
- ✓Affirmative action could also be applied to health and economic ventures.

Ways of Transforming Gender Relations (Cont.)

5. **Gender mainstreaming**

- ✓Is to ensure that before decisions are made, or plans implemented, analysis should always be made of the effects on and needs of both women and men.
- ❖Equal access to credit facilities
- ❖In education, opportunities should be made available to all irrespective of gender.

State and Civil Society Responses to Gender Inequalities

- State Responses to Gender Inequalities
- Civil Society Responses to Gender Inequalities

State Responses to Gender Inequalities

The responses of the state to gender inequalities in Ghana can be categorized into TWO (2): Institutional and legal reforms.

Institutional Reforms

- Setting up of the National Council on Women and Development (NCWD, now Department of Gender) 1975 to coordinate national effort on women issues.
- Creation of the Ministry of Women and Children Affairs (MOWAC) in 2001. The name of the Ministry was changed to Ministry of Gender and Social Protection in 2013 to refocus polices and programmes on gender issues

Institutional Reforms (Cont.)

- Setting up Girl-Child Units in the Ghana Education Service at National, Regional, District and School levels to promote girl-child education.
- Domestic Violence and Victim Support Unit (DOVVSU, formerly Women and Juvenile Unit) of the Ghana Police Service

Legal Reforms

- The enactment of the Interstate Succession Law, PNDC Law 111 of 1985
- The Criminal Code Amendment Act of 1994, section 69 criminalises FGM and those guilty are liable to imprisonment of not less 3years .
- Ghana’s Criminal Code Amendment Act of 1998 included sections that criminalises harmful traditional cultural practices.
- Domestic Violence Act of 2007 (Act 732)

Other State Responses

- Free Maternal Health
- Introduction of Social Interventions in education. (fCUBE, Capitation Grants, Free SHS, Free Sanitary pads etc.)
- Appointment of Women to key state institutions (Chief Justice, Speaker of Parliament, Electoral Commission etc.)

Civil Society Responses to Gender Inequalities

- The 31st December Women's Movement spearheaded the advocacy and got the Intestate Succession Law passed.
- Ghana Association for the Welfare of Women – leading educational campaign on the harmful effects of FGM and the laws against its practice
- International Needs Ghana (Trokosi)
- The Coalition on the Women's Manifesto led by ABANTU for Development, prepared the Women Manifesto for Ghana in 2004

Civil Society Responses to Gender Inequalities (Cont.)

- The National Coalition on Domestic Violence Legislation (DV Coalition, 2002)
- The Network for Women's Rights of Ghana (NETRIGHT, 1999)- Economic justice advocacy, women land rights, other areas of women rights
- Forum for African Women Educationalists (FAWE) -promoting girls education and supporting dropout girls to learn a trade
- International Federation of Women Lawyers (FIDA)- offers free legal services particularly for women and children who could not afford legal services of any kind because of their economic condition.

Civil Societies' Modus Operandi

- Formulation of laws and its enforcement
- Advocacy
- Call for Reforms – legal, cultural, etc
- Education – training, sensitization

END OF SLIDES